

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

ITEACH

ALTERNATIVE ROUTE

On-Site Review: April 9-10, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

ITEACH

ALTERNATIVE ROUTE

Overall Performance Level		
N/A		
* There's insufficient data from Standard 1 and Standard 3 to calculate an overall performance score.		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
N/A	MEETS	N/A

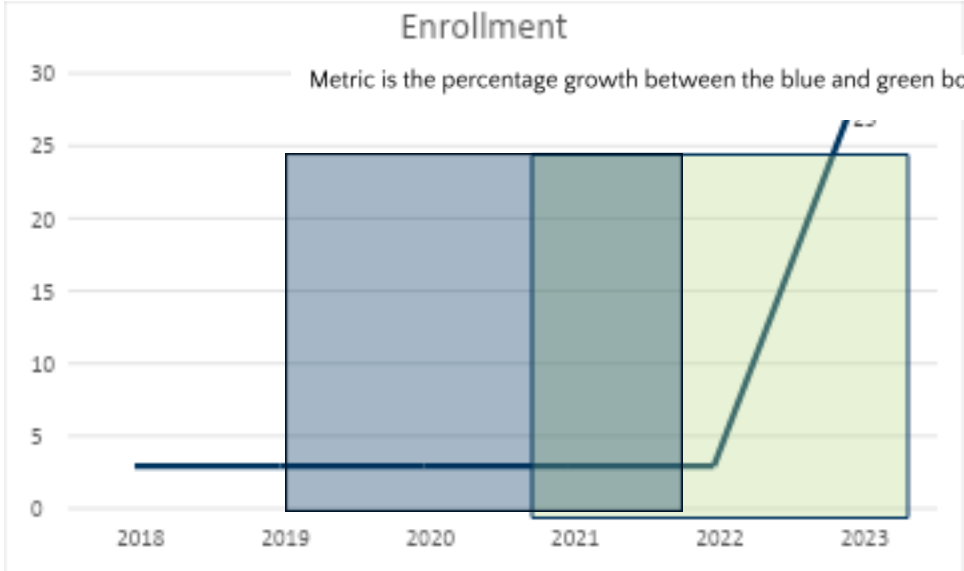
STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

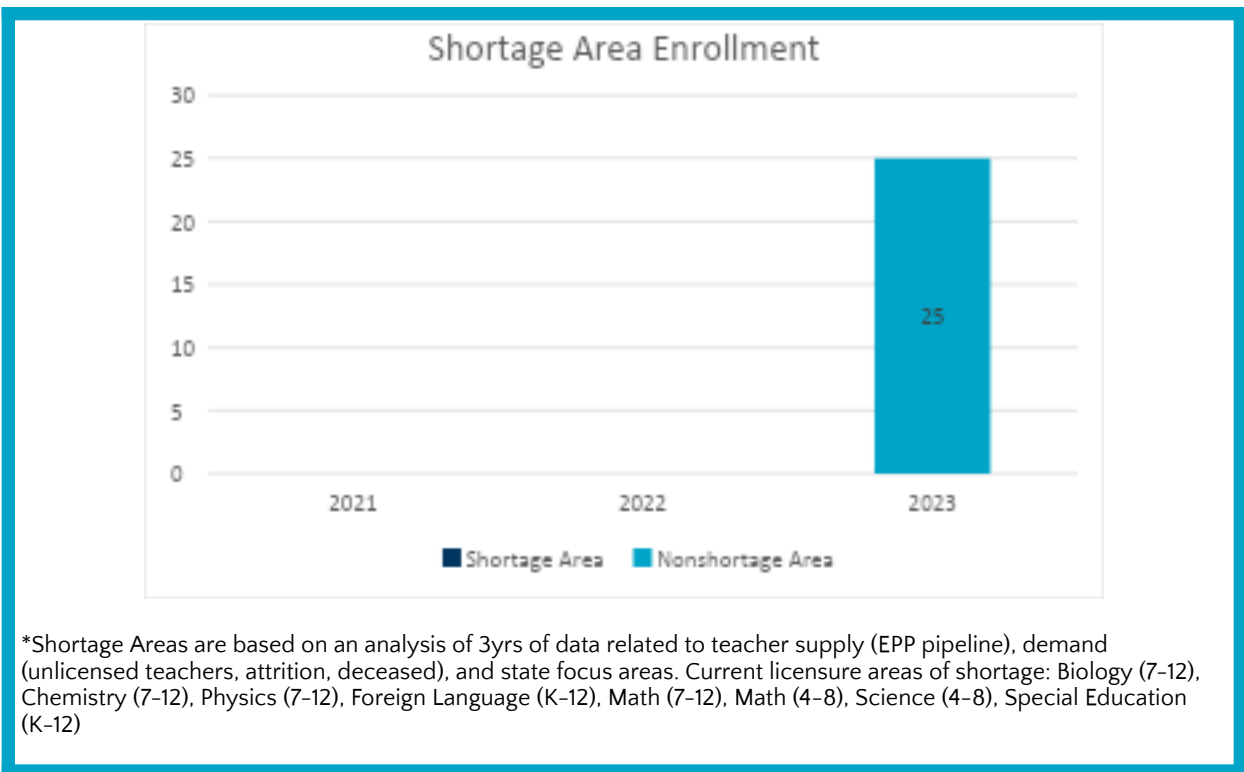
Standard 1 Performance Level		
N/A		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
BELOW	APPROACHING	N/A
Recommendations		
iTeach is unable to receive an overall Standard 1 rating, as this is a new first time licensure program in Arkansas and more data is needed to evaluate trends in recruitment and completion. iTeach should consider specifying the licensure area for enrollees when submitting individual enrollment data in the ETS Title II dashboard. Otherwise, DESE is unable to determine the percentage of enrollees in subject shortage areas.		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
BELOW	iTeach presented a comprehensive, proactive Annual Plan; however, the plan was submitted after the deadline after contact from DESE. Therefore, iTeach will receive a rating of Below

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	100%	EXCEEDS
Enrollment  Metric is the percentage growth between the blue and green boxes.			
*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a "Meets" rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an "Exceeds" rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.			
Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	0%	BELOW



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	N/A	N/A

Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
APPROACHING	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
iteach adequately prepares and supports teacher candidates throughout their coursework and clinical experience. The EPP provides a flexible program that allows candidates to earn their teaching license through a sequenced, yet self-paced, program. School partners are pleased with the teachers who come through iteach and candidates feel supported and prepared to enter the classroom. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - Audit coursework for classroom connections, ensuring that instructors provide models of instruction, incorporate high-quality instructional materials, and clearly and intentionally familiarize candidates with Arkansas K-12 Standards that allow opportunities for vertical alignment. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1a Metrics 1 and 2</i>) - Consistently use the Aspiring Teacher Rubric in all teacher observations and feedback. Provide ATR-aligned ratings on teacher candidate observations. Training on the rubric should be completed for clinical supervisors and norming should continue throughout the year. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.2b Metric 4, 2.3b Metric 3</i>) - Document a clear and intentional system to recognize high performing teacher candidates and offer opportunities and feedback that encourage their retention; this may be in collaboration with partner school leaders and/or experienced mentor teachers. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 2.3b Metric 4</i>)		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based APPROACHING
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction APPROACHING Coursework incorporates some nationally recognized best practices around content instruction. The iteach catalog outlines clear expectations and goals throughout the program showing competency-based learning. Candidates receive instruction in learning theories, Bloom's Taxonomy, pedagogy, and strategies for working with diverse learners.

In Literacy, 21st Century Instruction Pedagogical Content Knowledge (TCAR 5400) candidates are exposed to the Science of Reading (SOR) and complete aligned quizzes, assignments and assessments. One assignment requires candidates to develop an integrated lesson plan that incorporates reading instruction and another content area. Learner Development (TCAR 5200) provides introductory content that includes the InTASC standards and behavior management best practices. However, there is a lack of explicit emphasis on HQIM and insufficient guidance on evaluating and selecting high-quality materials. Although a link to DESE's High Quality Instructional Material (HQIM) was introduced in two courses (TCAR 5400 and TCAR 5700), HQIM has not yet been fully integrated into the coursework.

Focus group participants confirmed these findings. Participants in the Coursework focus group discussed that they are required to complete a course on the SOR and complete the modules in Arkansas Ideas for awareness in SOR. However, out of the four candidates, none were able to give examples that illustrated their recognition nor use of HQIM in instruction. In the course walkthrough, one participant mentioned that the EPP is partnering with Harvard University in a study about how to incorporate HQIM in writing lesson plans and currently there are plans in place to incorporate these learnings when they are published.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

APPROACHING

Coursework somewhat incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction. In the documentation, reviewers observed that SOR standards are incorporated into Literacy, 21st Century Instruction Pedagogical Content Knowledge (TCAR 5400). Another example from the documentation was seen in the student accommodations and differentiation module that is incorporated into Learner Differences and Adaptations for Students with Disabilities (TCAR 5500). Additional training regarding, ELL and differentiation for diverse learners is incorporated into Diverse Student Populations, English Language Learners and Bilingual Students (TCAR 5600).

In the coursework walk-through, reviewers noted that assignments require candidates to align lesson objectives, instructional strategies and assessments to Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards. In the Coursework focus group, candidates shared they are required to develop lesson plans that explicitly align with Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards. One candidate reported using printed standards and highlighting them during lesson planning to ensure full coverage and student readiness for state assessments such as ATLAS and the ACT.

Although reviewers saw many examples of working with AR Academic State Standards, they did not observe evidence of intentionally providing candidates opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework providing candidates an opportunity to show proficiency. The structure of the program ensures that candidates move through the coursework in a specific order, with each course designed to build upon the previous one. This sequencing allows candidates to progress at their own pace and candidates must demonstrate proficiency before advancing to the next course.

Courses also include clear assessments and reinforcement opportunities to support candidate growth. Each course has clearly defined goals for each module, with candidates required to show understanding through quizzes, assignments, and cumulative assessments. For example, candidates in TCAR 5200 (Learner Development) learn foundational strategies, which they then integrate into their lesson plans in subsequent courses like Literacy, 21st Century Instruction Pedagogical Content Knowledge (TCAR 5400). This progression allows candidates to apply and refine the skills they have learned as they advance through the program. One participant explained, "We must pass each course to move to the next, and the modules follow a similar format, so we always know what to expect."

Focus group data substantiates the effectiveness of the program's course sequencing and flexible structure. Candidates reported a positive experience with the self-paced nature of the program, with one participant noting, "I was able to get through my coursework quickly (three weeks)", while another took advantage of the long breaks since

her school is a year-round school. This flexibility allows candidates to move through coursework at a pace that accommodates their individual schedules while maintaining a focus on mastery of the required material.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework
MEETS

Coursework clearly incorporates Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills of their required licensure area. The Arkansas Teaching Standards are aligned at the assignment level for each course, as evidenced by crosswalks at the beginning of each syllabus. Coursework incorporates the Arkansas Teacher Standards (InTASC) into coursework while allowing candidates time to learn material then complete coursework through assignments, quizzes, and assessments. Sample lesson plans show candidates' ability to incorporate K-12 content standards into their lesson planning.

In the course walk through, reviewers noted all coursework is aligned to the InTASC standards, and assessments in You're Hired (TCAR 5700) show candidate proficiency in the standards.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience
MEETS

Candidates have structured opportunities to apply their learning during the two-semester residency as a teacher of record on a provisional license as part of the You're Hired (5700) course. Over the course of the review, the EPP shared that they use the CARE form and the Arkansas Aspiring Teacher (ATR) rubric which provides candidates feedback on their teaching five times during their culminating course. There are two reflection assignments that require candidates to show proficiency on the ten InTASC standards.

Focus group feedback provides additional insight into how candidates engage with the alignment between coursework and clinical experience. Candidates reflected on how their coursework prepared them for their clinical responsibilities, with one candidate stating, "My course instructors helped me figure out ways to differentiate during my lessons, and that feedback helped me a lot when I was teaching." Although most candidates do not submit lesson plans for their school districts, they do submit them for the iteach program as part of their observation process. One candidate shared, "I'm able to connect what I learned in the courses to what I'm doing in the classroom. The feedback from my clinical supervisor and course instructors helps me improve my teaching skills, especially in areas where I need growth."

Observations of coursework implementation confirm alignment between coursework and clinical experience occurs primarily in You're Hired (TCAR 5700), where candidates are hired to teach and are assessed based on their current classroom context. Early courses (5100-5600) do not have direct clinical experience components but instead focus on foundational pedagogical skills through video-based learning. As one course instructor noted, "The culminating assignment in TCAR 5400 requires candidates to develop a behavior management plan, which is intended to be useful during their clinical experience." However, in You're Hired (TCAR 5700), candidates engage in real teaching experiences, with their assignments, observations, and assessments directly tied to their roles as teachers. They have two major reflection assignments aligned to the InTASC standards: one reflecting on their lowest-scored observation components and another on their Impact on Student Learning project. Candidates must demonstrate proficiency in these areas prior to program completion, ensuring that their clinical experience is intentionally aligned with coursework.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors
MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors
MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K-12 Standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. The iteach course instructor roster confirms all instructors hold valid teaching certificates and at least a master's degree. iteach facilitates an annual summer conference for its instructors. Breakout sessions take a deep dive into state standards. Quarterly and monthly meetings are held between the team leads and instructors both in whole group settings as well as individual meetings.

Coursework focus group participants consistently reported that instructors provided detailed, timely feedback on assignments and fostered a deeper understanding of key instructional concepts. One candidate described a particularly helpful interaction, stating, "I had to resubmit my assignment, and the instructor explained the difference between modifications and accommodations in a way that finally made sense." Participants in the Course Instructor

focus group noted that iteach maintains high standards through structured supports such as an annual summer conference with breakout sessions focused on specific state standards, including Arkansas standards. One instructor explained, "I have experience in curriculum, so I was assigned to teach the planning course," highlighting alignment of instructor expertise to course content.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. iteach has implemented "end of course" and "exit surveys" and provided an analysis and key insights of candidate's perceptions about coursework. Instructor feedback is provided on an annual basis from iteach administrators. Instructors are also encouraged to share feedback and suggestions for improvement. They participate in quarterly meetings that provide information regarding the curriculum and training. During the course walk through, the instructor shared that instructors meet at least monthly with the course lead to discuss course updates and conduct norming sessions. In addition, faculty meet with their lead individually for feedback on their grading and areas of improvement. All course instructors are required to give thorough, timely feedback (within two-three days), and meet with candidates face to face or on zoom if more than two revisions are needed. This was confirmed by participants in the Coursework focus group who gave specific examples of feedback being provided within three days of assignment submission.

Participants in the Course Instructors focus group also shared that they provide prompt feedback to their candidates that is specific to each element of the rubric. If candidates are not achieving mastery, video conferences and/or face to face meetings are held to determine the best course of action to help the candidate.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences builds off previous experiences. Due to the nature of the alternative route programs, teacher candidates' clinical experience begins once they are hired as a teacher of record. Throughout their coursework, there are opportunities for learning and development through the use of the Teaching Channel Video Library that candidates subscribe to. During the two-semester long clinical internship, candidates are observed three times in the first semester and twice in the second semester.

Both clinical supervisors agreed that the overall sequence of clinical experiences intentionally builds to include opportunities for learning and development. There are opportunities for learning and development through the five observations that candidates receive; the reflections that are conducted on the feedback and through the creation of a portfolio of student work to examine the impact on student learning. Clinical experience focus group participants described the structure more candidly, recognizing that "the overall sequence of clinical experiences does not exist" due to being placed in full teaching roles immediately. However, they emphasized meaningful growth through repeated observations, feedback reflections, and portfolio development designed to assess their impact on student learning, highlighting intentionality in design, if not in sequence.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. Each candidate serves as the teacher of record, and therefore, are naturally exposed to a wide variety of students with varied needs. Throughout their coursework, candidates watch recorded videos from The Teaching Channel. The Teaching Channel is referenced as a key component in providing access to a broader range of student needs and teaching contexts.

Candidates confirmed they regularly use Teaching Channel videos to observe strategies for differentiation and behavior management. One candidate shared, "Watching the videos helped me understand how to modify lessons for different learning needs—I saw a lot of real examples I could adapt."

Coursework observations confirmed the structure of clinical experiences during the program, especially during the culminating You're Hired (TCAR 5700) course, which provides candidates with opportunities to apply their knowledge with students in real classrooms. Candidates complete reflection assignments that address how they meet the needs of diverse learners.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

APPROACHING

From the evidence provided to reviewers, some experienced mentor teachers are equipped to support and develop teacher candidate's pedagogical development. Each provided a roster of mentor teachers, however the data was incomplete, and reviewers could not confirm all mentor teachers met the required criteria.

Both participants in the Clinical Experience focus group felt their mentors helped them with both personal and professional responsibilities. One participant stated that his mentor helped him to increase his confidence in certain situations. The other participant shared she spent two days with her mentor before moving to her own classroom, which "helped her feel more comfortable in the classroom and to incorporate reading strategies."

Both participants in the Clinical Supervisor focus group agreed that all candidates are provided a mentor, however, there are limited interactions between the mentor and clinical supervisor. Supervisors email a copy of their observation notes to the mentor teacher and try to check in with them while onsite but are not always able to. No evidence was provided to demonstrate effective coaching skills by experienced mentor teachers, such as evaluation data, trackers, or observations.

Note: By 2026–2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers
APPROACHING

A partial process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers. iteach relies on their school partners to select experienced mentor teachers for their candidates and are not involved in the placement process, outside of sharing contact information.

Both participants in the Partnership focus group shared that all mentor teachers must meet the DESE requirements to serve as a mentor teacher in their districts. Both agreed that their mentor teachers must demonstrate leadership skills and be effective in their own classroom before being asked to serve as a mentor teacher.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors
MEETS

Most clinical supervisors meet expectations for background experience, holding at least five years of successful K–12 classroom teaching, a master’s degree or higher, and a valid teaching credential. To support their development as instructional coaches, clinical supervisors are required to complete coaching training as well as participate in an online course specific to their role.

In one coaching observation, the clinical supervisor used reflective prompts like, “How do you anticipate misunderstandings?” and “When they are through, how are they going to communicate what they have learned?” Coaching conversations encouraged thoughtful reflection.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates
APPROACHING

Candidates sometimes receive high-quality feedback from their clinical supervisor. Evidence is primarily connected to the CARE rubric. Candidates are observed five times during their clinical experience (three times in the first semester and twice in the second), and each observation is followed by a formal feedback session. Documentation also shows that candidates are required to reflect on their practice—such as addressing students’ “learning differences.”

Clinical supervisors reported delivering feedback using the CARE and Aspiring Teacher rubrics during observations, though they are less familiar with ATR. One supervisor shared that feedback is both oral and written, and that candidates track their own progress using reflective journals throughout the clinical experience. The mentor teacher in the focus group indicated that verbal feedback is given “two to three times a week,” creating ongoing opportunities for developmental conversations. Candidates described these interactions as helpful, with one candidate noting that she regularly seeks feedback from her mentor on “strengths and weaknesses.”

In three coaching observations, reviewers observed opportunities for coaches to continue to grow their instructional coaching practices. In one observation, no reference was made to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, and reviewers noted “no actionable next steps were offered, and key instructional levers for growth were not identified.” Another observation showed partial alignment, with the supervisor referencing the ATR and identifying general areas of strength and growth but failing to provide strategies to help the candidate use their strengths to address challenges. Additionally, there was no documentation of how the candidate’s practice improved over time or evidence of measurable impact.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024–25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place with partner schools and districts. iteach has an MOU with school districts and the Program Director serves as the primary point of contact at the district level. Evidence submitted demonstrates the program director connects with the principal on candidate progress throughout candidate residencies. At the end of field experiences, principals are asked to submit a short survey to provide feedback on how the internship went and how well prepared their candidate was. One hundred percent of principals said the internship was successful.

School partners and the experienced mentor teacher shared positive experiences about their partnership with iteach, saying the communication is open and they receive quick responses when they reach out. One school partner said, "We have a great working relationship with iteach." Another highlighted a positive impact of the program, "The impact of the partnership is to help develop a "Grow-Your-Own" model with the school districts to allow former employees and students to earn a salary and increase the number of teachers in our district." While formalized structures for collaboration vary by partner site, the frequency and modes of communication indicate intentional partnership efforts that support clinical experience for the partner school, teacher candidate and iteach.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are consistently in place that support and develop effective clinical supervisors through a field supervisor handbook that outlines key responsibilities, coaching expectations, and guidance for providing high-quality candidate feedback. The handbook also includes suggested protocols and timelines for supervisor engagement with candidates, offering a standardized framework for ongoing candidate support. Additionally, clinical supervisors are expected to reference tools such as the Aspiring Teacher Rubric and CARE form, aligning their coaching practices with performance expectations and ensuring consistency across placements.

The Program Director indicated that field supervisors receive training in Diane Sweeney's student-centered coaching model and must complete ATR training. In the summer, all clinical supervisors complete training that reviews their role and responsibilities including information about candidate reflections, observations and feedback.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

The AR Coursework Progress Monitoring spreadsheet shows that iteach candidates are meeting requirements in their coursework. The average course grade is 93.8 (out of 100) for iteach candidates. Evidence shows that candidates have met requirements on all assignments within two resubmissions.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are provided with individualized support plans. Documentation shows that the EPP has formal systems in place to support candidates who are not meeting coursework expectations. A Growth Plan Form Template exists for candidates identified as "off-track," and the candidate Salesforce profile functions as a centralized system to track individual progress through the program. These tools provide a clear structure for monitoring and intervention, including space for goals, timelines, and required actions. Although there haven't been any iteach Arkansas candidates placed on a formal growth plan as of March 2025, the infrastructure for individualized support is clearly defined.

Candidates are allowed to resubmit coursework assignments twice and can request a third resubmission if they are still not meeting requirements. Both instructors in the Course Instructor focus group shared that if a candidate does not meet expectations after two rounds of feedback on a course assignment, a zoom or face to face meeting is scheduled where the instructor and candidate discuss the assignment, the feedback, and to clarify assignment expectations. This is a planned intervention for anyone in need of this line of extra support. One instructor noted that in the five years she has worked for iteach she has needed to utilize this form of intervention less than five times. Additionally in the field experience course there are clinical supervisors, course instructors, as well as mentors in the schools to provide support for candidates during their first year of teaching.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones
MEETS

The EPP has established appropriate milestones for candidate's clinical internship, and most candidates meet the goals and milestones. Candidates must successfully pass each course before enrolling in the next course and before advancing to their internship experience. During their internship year, all candidates complete two semesters of field experience where they must complete two reflection assignments and be observed at least three times in the first semester and two times in the second semester. As of March 2025, iteach Arkansas has seven program completers. Of these, 85% (6 out of 7) have been issued a standard license.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth
MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. Through the You're Hired (TCAR 5700) Reflection 2 Capstone Project, candidates submit a portfolio-based assessment that includes creating lesson plans aligned to standards, gathering and analyzing student data and completing a student outcome analysis to determine the effectiveness of their instruction. Field Supervisors provide feedback and an overall rating on their project.

Participants in the Clinical Supervisor focus group shared that they review MAPS testing with candidates and review scores and make goals for individual students. The Experienced Mentor Teacher also reviews ATLAS data with their candidate and saw student growth from fall to winter in their candidate's student data.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills
APPROACHING

The EPP provided examples of walk-through observation data that included scores aligned with the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. However, due to the early-stage implementation of the ATR, there was no data on the number of candidates receiving an end-of-year rating of "effective", and the EPP did not submit evidence of data or coaching trackers to show that at least 80% of participants are receiving overall scores of "effective". The EPP has started to implement the ATR, but the review team did not observe enough evidence to warrant a "meets" rating.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship
APPROACHING

Candidates are provided support in their clinical internship. Candidates receive feedback from their clinical supervisor and progress is monitored in student portfolios. iteach has a process to place struggling candidates on a growth plan. Growth plans are created by the principal and field supervisor. No Arkansas candidates have been placed on a growth plan.

Both participants in the Clinical Supervisor focus group agreed that if support was needed, they would reach out to iteach to connect the candidate with an instructional coach. The clinical supervisors are not aware of who the instructional coaches are but encourage teacher candidates to reach out to them, or their mentor teacher, if they are struggling. The mentor teacher expressed they would be there to support the candidate – and they listed examples of how they support their current candidate, including modeling, opportunities to observe other classrooms, watching training videos or meeting with the candidate.

iteach referred to recognition for high performing candidates, but these efforts are across the full iteach program and not specific to Arkansas teachers. There was no evidence submitted that Arkansan candidates had been recognized through any of their program-level efforts.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
N/A		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
N/A	N/A	N/A
Recommendations		
iTeach is unable to receive an overall Standard 3 rating, as this is a new first time licensure program in Arkansas and more data is needed to evaluate trends in licensure, employment, and effectiveness. Available data shows working enrollees were not employed under a provisional license. iTeach should evaluate protocols around tracking enrollee employment and support these candidates in securing provisional licensure.		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year of completion.	80%	N/A	N/A
Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed			

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level												
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	0%	BELOW												
Provisional Licensure <table><caption>Provisional Licensure Data</caption><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Provisionally Licensed</th><th>Not Licensed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2021</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr><tr><td>2022</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr><tr><td>2023</td><td>0</td><td>2</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Provisionally Licensed	Not Licensed	2021	0	0	2022	0	0	2023	0	2
Year	Provisionally Licensed	Not Licensed													
2021	0	0													
2022	0	0													
2023	0	2													
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try															
Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level												
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	N/A	N/A												

INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	N/A	N/A
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	N/A	N/A
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas. Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education. Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.			
Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3	Performance Level

		Years After Completion	
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	N/A	N/A

INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	N/A	N/A
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	N/A	N/A
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	N/A	N/A

